LEARNING
MADE SIMPLE

Main Topic and Key Details

Grade 1 Reading | Reading Comprehension

Name: _____ Date: _____

What Is This Text About?

Read the facts. Circle the word that tells what the whole text is about.

Bats are animals.
Bats can fly.
Bats sleep in the day.
Bats fly at night.
Many bats eat bugs.



What is this text about? Circle the word.

Bats Night Bugs

Word bank

night day bugs

When do bats fly?

_____

What do many bats eat?

_____

When do bats sleep?

_____

Adult: The child reads the facts first.
The main topic is what the whole text is about, not just one fact.

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Find the Key Details

Read the facts. Write the main topic. Then circle three facts.

A butterfly starts as a small egg on a leaf.
A caterpillar comes out of the egg.
The caterpillar eats leaves and grows big.
Then it makes a hard case.
The case is called a chrysalis.
A butterfly comes out of the case.



What is this text about?

_____

Circle the three facts that are in the text.

The caterpillar eats flowers.

The egg is on a leaf.

The butterfly sleeps in a nest.

The caterpillar eats leaves.

A butterfly comes out of a chrysalis.

Adult: The child reads the facts first.
A key detail is a fact the text really tells.

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Ask and Answer

Read the facts. Answer the questions with words from the word bank.

Your heart is in your chest.
It is about as big as your fist.
Your heart pumps blood all around your body.
Blood helps your body grow and stay strong.
When you run and play, your heart beats fast.
When you rest, your heart beats slow.



chest **pumps blood** **run and play** **rest**

Where is your heart?

_____

What does your heart do?

_____

When does your heart beat fast?

_____

Adult: The child reads the facts first.
Every answer is in the text.

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How Are These Facts Connected?

Read the facts. Draw a line to match each cause to what happens.

The Moon is in the sky at night.
The Moon has no light of its own.
The Sun lights up the Moon.
That is why the Moon shines.
The Moon moves around the Earth.
As it moves, we see more of the bright part, or less of it.
That is why the Moon looks different each night.



Why it happens	What happens
The Sun lights up the Moon.	The Moon shines.
The Moon moves around the Earth.	It looks different each night.

Why does the Moon shine?

The Moon shines because _____

Adult: The child reads the facts first.
One fact makes another fact happen.

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Tell It Back

Read the facts. Write the main topic. Then write three facts you learned.

A train runs on tracks.
A train has an engine and cars.
The engine pulls the cars.
Trains carry people and things.
Trains stop at stations.
People get on and off at a station.



What is this text about?

Write three facts you learned from the text.

tracks | engine | cars | stations | people

Adult: The child reads the facts first, then tells them back in order.

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